

KID CITY · CITY CHURCH LUFKIN



ALLERGY & MEDICAL PROTOCOL

Keeping every child healthy, safe, and cared for

LOVE GOD · LOVE OTHERS · BE YOU · HAVE FUN





01

PURPOSE & OVERVIEW

Why this protocol exists.

OUR COMMITMENT TO HEALTH & SAFETY

Kid City is committed to caring for every child as if they were our own. That means taking every allergy, medical condition, and health concern seriously — from the first hello at Check-In to the final pick-up. This protocol exists so every volunteer knows exactly how to respond, every time.

This document covers allergy management, medication policies, illness exclusion, wellness screening, emergency procedures, and the forms required for special medical needs. Every Kid City volunteer is expected to be familiar with this entire protocol.

THE WIN

Every parent drops off their child confident their medical needs are known, respected, and managed with care.

02

ALLERGY MANAGEMENT

Identifying, communicating, and responding to allergies.

AT CHECK-IN: FLAGGING ALLERGIES

Allergies are identified and flagged during the check-in process. Every volunteer must know how to identify and respond to allergy flags before serving.

FLAG	WHAT IT MEANS	ACTION REQUIRED
YELLOW sticker on badge	Food or environmental allergy present	Read the allergy details on the badge. Do not give this child any food or snacks. Notify the room leader immediately.
RED sticker on child badge + parent tag	Security or safety concern	Notify Safety Team immediately. Extra caution on pick-up verification.

COMMON ALLERGENS — WHAT TO WATCH FOR

Kid City does not serve food as part of regular programming. However, snacks may be present in craft materials, activities, or items brought in by families. Always be aware of the following common allergens:



- **Peanuts & Tree Nuts** — Most common severe allergen. Check all craft materials, play dough, and any food items. Never allow nut-containing snacks near an allergic child.
- **Milk & Dairy** — Common in babies and toddlers. Follow parent feeding instructions exactly. Do not substitute formulas or milk products.
- **Eggs** — May appear in craft materials (e.g., some play doughs). Check ingredient labels.
- **Wheat & Gluten** — Present in many craft materials including modeling clays. Notify parents if craft materials cannot be verified.
- **Latex** — Some medical gloves and balloon materials contain latex. Use nitrile/vinyl gloves if a latex allergy is flagged.
- **Insect Stings** — If a stinging insect is found inside the building, notify staff immediately. Do not wait for a child to be stung.
- **Environmental (Dust, Pet Dander, Pollen)** — Ensure rooms are clean before service. If a child shows respiratory distress, page parents immediately.

ANAPHYLAXIS — SEVERE ALLERGIC REACTION

■ ANAPHYLAXIS IS A LIFE-THREATENING EMERGENCY

If a child shows signs of a severe allergic reaction, call 911 FIRST. Then administer the child's prescribed epinephrine auto-injector (EpiPen) if one is on file and you are trained to do so. Notify the team leader and page parents immediately.

Signs of anaphylaxis include:

- Difficulty breathing, wheezing, or shortness of breath
- Swelling of lips, tongue, throat, or face
- Hives, rash, or redness spreading rapidly across the body
- Vomiting, diarrhea, or stomach cramping following food exposure
- Sudden drop in blood pressure — child becomes pale, limp, or loses consciousness
- Child appears panicked, says 'I can't breathe' or 'my throat is closing'

ANAPHYLAXIS RESPONSE PROCEDURE

Step 1 — Call 911: Do not wait. Call 911 immediately at the first sign of a severe reaction. Do not wait to see if it gets worse.

Step 2 — Administer EpiPen (if authorized): If a Medical Authorization Form is on file and you are trained, administer the child's epinephrine auto-injector into the outer thigh. Hold for 10 seconds.

Step 3 — Page parents: Notify the Volunteer Leader with the child's name and sticker number. Parents will be paged to the check-in station.



Step 4 — Keep child calm and still: Lay the child flat with legs elevated unless they are having difficulty breathing — then let them sit up.

Step 5 — Meet emergency services: Send a volunteer to meet emergency responders at the building entrance and escort them to the room.

Step 6 — Complete Incident Report: Document the incident fully before leaving. Include timeline, symptoms observed, and actions taken.

03 ILLNESS & WELLNESS

Who should stay home — and when they can return.

■ SICK CHILDREN SHOULD NOT ATTEND KID CITY

We ask parents to keep their child home if they are showing any of the symptoms below. This protects all the children and volunteers in our care. Volunteers should gently but firmly ask parents to take a symptomatic child home. Contact your team lead for support if needed.

EXCLUSION CRITERIA — CHILD SHOULD NOT ATTEND IF:

SYMPTOM / CONDITION	RETURN CRITERIA
Fever over 100.4°F (38°C)	Fever-free for 24 hours without fever-reducing medication
Vomiting or diarrhea	Symptom-free for 24 hours
Common cold with colored nasal discharge	Clear discharge, fever-free, feeling well
Sore throat	If bacterial (strep): 24 hrs after starting antibiotics. If viral: symptom-free.
Untreated pink eye (conjunctivitis)	24 hours after beginning prescribed treatment
Unexplained rash or skin infection (boils, ringworm, impetigo)	Cleared by physician or rash determined non-contagious
Lice (eggs or nits present)	After complete treatment and nit-free inspection
Croup	When breathing is normal and fever-free
Chicken pox / measles / mumps / whooping cough	Cleared by physician — may require documentation
Any communicable disease	Physician clearance required



VOLUNTEER WELLNESS

Volunteers are also expected to stay home if they are ill. You cannot care for children when you are unwell — and you could spread illness to the most vulnerable members of our congregation. If you are sick, communicate with your team lead as early as possible so a substitute can be arranged.

✓ WHEN IN DOUBT, STAY HOME

It is always better to keep a child home than to risk spreading illness to babies, toddlers, or immunocompromised children in our care. We appreciate parents who make this thoughtful choice.

04

MEDICATION POLICY

What volunteers can and cannot administer.

■ KID CITY VOLUNTEERS DO NOT ADMINISTER MEDICATION

Volunteers will NOT administer any medication — including over-the-counter pain relievers, antihistamines, or cough medicine — except in a documented, pre-authorized life-threatening emergency. Medications should be given by a parent at home or before drop-off.

LIFE-THREATENING CONDITIONS — EXCEPTIONS

For children with documented life-threatening medical conditions (severe allergies, epilepsy, diabetes, etc.), a volunteer may administer a prescribed emergency medication ONLY when all of the following are true:

- A completed, signed Medical Authorization Form is on file at the Kid City Director's office.
- The specific medication (e.g., EpiPen, seizure rescue medication) is provided by the parent in labeled, original packaging.
- The administering volunteer has been trained for that specific medication and condition.
- 911 has been called or is being called simultaneously.

PARENT RESPONSIBILITIES

- Administer all routine medications (including antihistamines) before drop-off.
- Provide labeled emergency medication (EpiPen, etc.) in original, unexpired packaging if required.
- Complete and submit a Medical Authorization Form before your child's first Sunday if they have a life-threatening condition.
- Update the Kid City Director if your child's medical needs, prescriptions, or emergency protocols change.



05

NURSERY FEEDING PROTOCOLS

Safe feeding for babies and toddlers.

BOTTLE AND FOOD FEEDING

- Follow the parent's instructions exactly as provided. Do not substitute, supplement, or improvise.
- Ensure all bottles and food items are properly labeled with the child's name.
- Check for allergy flags on the child's badge before beginning any feeding.
- Only adult volunteers may administer bottles or food — student helpers may not feed infants or toddlers.
- Burp all infants after each bottle.
- Do not heat bottles in a microwave. Use warm water or a bottle warmer if available.
- If a child refuses to eat or drink, do not force feed. Page parents if the child appears hungry and is distressed.

FORMULA & BREAST MILK HANDLING

- Never mix up bottles — double-check the child's name before every feeding.
- Breast milk is body fluid — handle with care. Do not mix with another child's milk under any circumstances.
- Unused formula or breast milk remaining after feeding should be returned to the parent at pick-up. Do not discard without parent instruction.
- Dispose of any bottle left at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

■ ALLERGY DOUBLE-CHECK

Before every feeding: read the child's badge, confirm their name matches the label, and verify no allergy flag is present. If you are unsure about any food item — do not give it. Page the parent.

06

DIAPERING & HYGIENE

Health standards for early childhood care.

DIAPERING PROCEDURE

- Check diapers of all infants and toddlers during each service. If a child attends more than one service, check each time.
- Diapering must be performed at designated diaper stations within eyesight of other care providers — never in a private area.



- Cover the changing pad with fresh wax paper before each change.
- Prepare all supplies before placing the child on the table. Keep one hand on the child at all times.
- Wear disposable surgical gloves for every diaper change.
- Seal dirty diapers in a plastic bag before disposal. Discard wax paper and gloves immediately.
- Wash hands thoroughly after every diaper change.
- All babies must be changed before the end of service.
- Student volunteers may NOT change diapers.

HANDWASHING STANDARDS

Proper handwashing is the single most effective way to prevent illness in Kid City.

- Wash hands upon arrival — before touching any child or food item.
- After every diaper change.
- After assisting a child in the bathroom.
- Before and after any feeding.
- After handling bodily fluids of any kind.
- Before returning to a classroom from any outside area.

ROOM SANITATION

Rooms should be visually clean and sanitized before families begin arriving. Toys that have been mouthed by infants or toddlers should be set aside for sanitizing. Surfaces including changing tables, highchairs, and tables should be wiped down between services.

07

INCIDENTS & EMERGENCIES

How to respond and document.

■ LIFE-THREATENING EMERGENCIES — CALL 911 FIRST

Loss of consciousness · Significant blood loss · Difficulty breathing · Cardiac event · Severe allergic reaction. Call 911 immediately. Then notify your team leader. Never delay calling 911 to seek internal approval.

MINOR ACCIDENTS & INJURIES

For minor injuries (small cuts, scrapes, minor bumps): treat using the first-aid kit located in each room. Notify your team lead. Complete an Incident Report before leaving for the day. Be honest and transparent with



parents at pick-up — do not minimize or omit details.

INCIDENT REPORT REQUIREMENTS

- The witness of the accident must complete the report — not the team lead.
- Complete the report before leaving for the day — no exceptions.
- Use factual, objective language. Describe what you observed, not what you interpreted.
- Do not offer medical advice or diagnosis to parents.
- The team lead countersigns the report. A copy is kept on file at the Kid City office.

PAGING PARENTS FOR MEDICAL REASONS

- Child has been crying consistently for 10 or more minutes.
- Child shows any signs of illness (fever, vomiting, rash, etc.)
- Child has been injured — even if minor.
- Child has a significant behavioral episode that is not resolving.

How to page: Notify the Volunteer Leader with the child's name and security sticker number. The Leader contacts the Production Director via Planning Center Live — a message displays on screen in the adult service. The parent comes to Check-In and is escorted to the classroom.

08

FORMS

Required documentation for medical needs.

MEDICAL AUTHORIZATION FORM

This form must be completed by a parent or legal guardian before a child with a life-threatening condition may be cared for in Kid City. Submit to the Kid City Director.

Child's Full Name

Date of Birth

MM / DD / YYYY

Parent / Guardian Name

Relationship to Child



Home Phone

Cell Phone

Home Address

Street · City · State · Zip

Medical Condition / Diagnosis

e.g., severe peanut allergy, epilepsy, Type 1 diabetes

Medication Name & Dosage

Include brand and generic name if applicable

Emergency Administration Instructions

Describe when and exactly how to administer the medication

Known Allergies (if separate from above)

Physician Name & Contact

Name · Clinic · Phone

I authorize a Kid City adult volunteer to administer the above medication in the case of an emergency as described above. I understand that 911 will be called in any life-threatening situation.

Parent / Guardian Signature

(Sign on printed form)

Date

MM / DD / YYYY

ALLERGY ALERT CARD



For children with known food or environmental allergies, this card is kept with the Room Leader during service. It supplements the badge flag and provides detailed information for the care team.

Child's Full Name

Room / Age Group

Known Allergen(s)

List all — be specific (e.g., 'peanuts' not just 'nuts')

Symptoms of a Reaction

What does a reaction look like for this child specifically?

Emergency Response Instructions

What should volunteers do if a reaction occurs?

Emergency Medication On-Site

Name · Location (e.g., 'EpiPen in blue bag with Room Leader')

Parent Cell

(Reachable during service)

Emergency Contact

Name · Phone

Questions or concerns?

Contact the Kid City Director at City Church Lufkin.
citychurchlufkin.com · Updated June 2026